

D7 · Integrated revenue plan, FY27–FY29

Revenue Strategy Lead, Office of the CRO · Week 8, FY27 · Strata Sense Technologies is fictional; all data synthetic (MBA capstone). Model: D7_Integrated_Model.xlsx (one workbook owns every number in this memo). ₹ crore unless stated.

1. Recommendation

Approve the Base plan: ₹14.95 crore of incremental investment in FY27, inside the ₹15 crore envelope, 6 net new AEs from Q3 FY27, 3 channel roles, and a ₹2.82 crore reserve released at the Q2 review only if the triggers in section 12 are met. It takes ARR from ₹310 crore to ₹350.9 crore in FY27, ₹422.7 crore in FY28 and ₹525.5 crore in FY29. FY29 ARR clears the board path (₹521.9 crore) by ₹3.6 crore; FY28 growth meets 20%; FY27 growth is 13.2%, ₹5.6 crore short of the 15% path. I am asking the board to accept that FY27 shortfall rather than fund it, for the reasons in section 4.

Test (brief §6)	FY27	FY28	FY29	Result
Closing ARR (₹ cr) / growth	350.9 / 13.2%	422.7 / 20.4%	525.5 / 24.3%	FY27 short of 15% (defended); FY28, FY29 met
Net revenue retention	99.1%	101.9%	103.8%	Short of 108% goal (defended)
Gross margin after partner margin (floor 66%)	68.6%	67.5%	67.7%	Met; depends on hardware attach falling (§6)
CAC payback, margin-adjusted (≤ 30 every quarter; ≤ 24 by Q4 FY28)	Q1 31.0; Q2–Q4 28.1–29.4	Q4: 21.2	17.3–20.6	One breach: Q1 FY27 (locked); exception requested
S&M as % of ARR (≤ 30% by FY29)	33.4%	30.6%	27.0%	Met
Incremental investment (envelope ₹15 cr in FY27)	14.95	20.35	26.55	Met
Net new AEs (≤ 12 in FY27) / channel roles (≤ 6)	6 / 3	8 / 5	6 / 6	Met
EBITDA (₹ cr)	-25.9	2.6	52.6	Break-even in FY28
Partner share of new-logo ARR (goal 25% by FY29)	8.5%	15.2%	22.7%	Short (defended)

Why this over doing nothing. Doing nothing is not flat. If FY24–26 trends continue (win rate falling from 27% to 17%, NRR from 118% to 99%), ARR reaches ₹389 crore in FY29, ₹137 crore below the plan. The three-year investment of ₹61.9 crore pays back in 8.0 months against that path, and in 10.5 months even against the stricter test that credits only gains beyond FY26 performance.

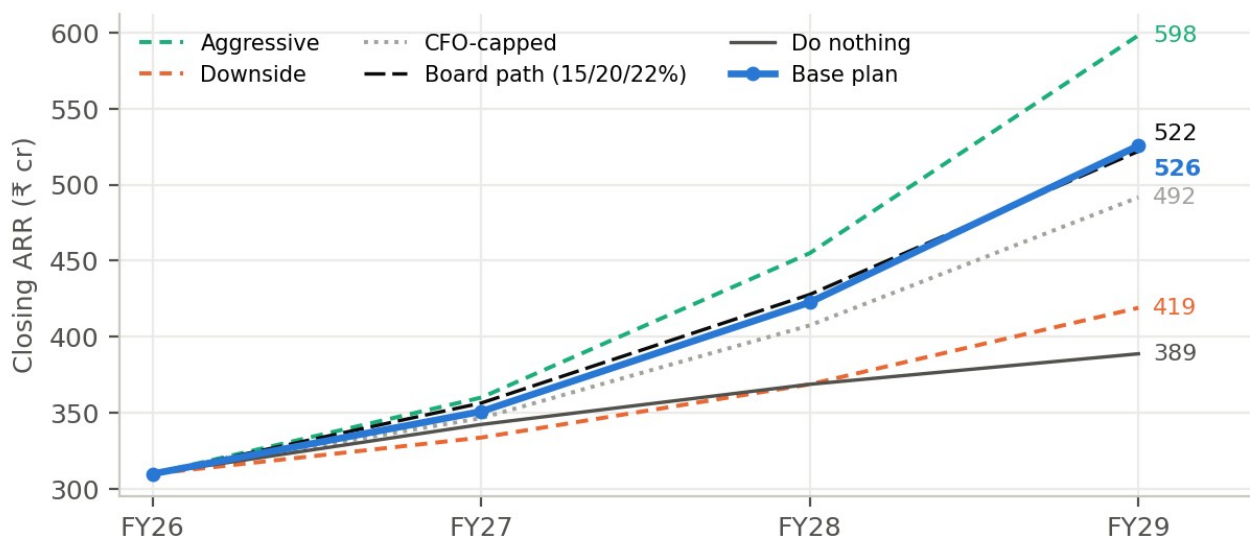


Exhibit 1. Closing ARR by scenario against the board path and the do-nothing path (model: Scenarios, Do_nothing).

2. How the model works

One workbook owns every number. Deliverables D1–D6 now read from it; where an earlier deliverable showed a different figure (D2's ₹46.5 crore new-logo need, D4's scenarios, D6's share denominator), this model supersedes it and the Checks sheet reconciles D6 partner ARR to the rupee.

- **Capacity.** AEs are tracked in four tenure bands (0–6, 6–12, 12–24, 24+ months) with hiring, attrition by band and next-quarter backfill. Ramped-AE equivalents use D1's measured productivity by tenure (weights 0 / 0.33 / 0.66 / 1.0), not management's six-month ramp assumption, which the data rejected.
- **Bookings.** Deals closed per quarter = ramped AEs × 5.4 deals carried at once × 3 ÷ sales cycle, capped by qualified pipeline supply. Direct ARR = deals × win rate × list deal × (1 – discount). All drivers move linearly from their FY26 actuals to each year's scenario value, so improvement phases in. Q1 FY27 is the locked D4 forecast (₹8.71 crore), because that quarter was under way before the plan.
- **Channel.** D6's cohort model (activations, 15% / 60% / 100% ramp, ₹1.2 crore mature productivity) produces partner ARR, counted once: partner deals are not in direct bookings, and the AE's 50% quota credit is compensation only.
- **ARR bridge and P&L.** Quarterly: opening + direct + partner + expansion – contraction – churn – the Vajra re-tender = closing, with a zero-difference check every quarter. Revenue, gross margin (partner margin charged to cost of revenue for the floor test), S&M, R&D, G&A, EBITDA and CAC payback on the board-pack definition.
- **Controls.** A scenario switch (Base, Downside, Aggressive, CFO-capped), five sensitivity shift cells plus a “share of plan delivered” lever, a Cascade sheet, and a Checks sheet with every guardrail. There are no plugs: every calculation cell is a formula or a labelled input traced in Appendix A.

3. The plan: five programmes and what each is expected to move

Programme	FY27 cost (₹ cr)	Driver moved in the model	FY26 → FY29 (Base)	Evidence
1. Target the right accounts (tiering, programme reallocation)	within existing ₹24 cr budget	Win rate (mix); qualified pipeline supply	Mix +2.9 pts; supply 392 → 470 deals	D1 targeting root cause (₹8.0 cr); D2 back-test
2. Win-rate and price discipline (value selling, battlecards, paid pilots, discount cap)	0.92 + 0.64 + 0.32 reserve	Win rate; discount; deal size; cycle	Win 17.1% → 22.5%; discount 19.3% → 15%; cycle 8.1 → 7.3 months	D3 role-play and proposal; D5 win/loss; D1 discount creep (₹3.1 cr)
3. Retention and Helix defence (squads, renewal protection, top-30 expansion, Vajra)	1.52 + 0.80 + 0.82 + 0.9 + 1.6 reserve	Churn; contraction; expansion; Vajra loss probability	Churn 5.9% → 4.0%; expansion 8.1% → 10.5%; Vajra 45% → 20%	D1 Helix bundle (₹34 cr/yr, largest cause); Inject 2; Inject 4
4. AE capacity (hiring to pipeline, retention pool)	1.99 + 1.00	Ramped AEs; attrition	64 → 83 AEs; attrition 29% → 20%	D1 tenure productivity; DR3 attrition
5. Selective channel (SEA, Gulf, machine builders)	2.44 + 0.40	Partner ARR	₹2.6 cr → ₹19.7 cr	D6; Inject 3
Enablers: RevOps and forecasting; sensor-agnostic readiness	1.00 + 0.60	Forecast accuracy; hardware attach from Q4 FY27	Attach 1.48 → 1.05 per ₹1 of new + expansion ARR	D4; D1 SENSOR-REUSE

Honesty about attribution: the model attaches each programme to the drivers it should move, but the size of each driver change is a judgement anchored in D1–D6 evidence, not a measured effect. That is why section 8 tests how much of the planned improvement must be delivered before the plan stops paying back.

What the plan fixes from the D1 diagnosis

D1 root cause	ARR at stake (D1, per year)	Plan lever in the model	Recovered by FY29 (per year, approx.)	What is left
Helix bundle: retention and new-logo losses in Helix-incumbent plants	₹34.0 cr (25.6 retention + 8.4 new logo)	Churn 5.9% → 4.0%; Vajra plan; Helix-incumbent win held at 7%	≈ ₹8.0 cr (1.9 pts × FY29 opening ARR) + ₹2.6 cr Vajra	≈ ₹24 cr: a packaging and pricing decision (sensor-agnostic tier), not a sales fix; D8
Expansion stall in non-Helix accounts	₹9.9 cr	Expansion 8.1% → 10.5% of opening ARR	≈ ₹10.1 cr	Recovered, if the top-30 programme works
Wrong accounts and single-threaded deals	₹8.0 cr	Tier mix +2.9 pts of win rate; pipeline supply	≈ ₹8.8 cr	Recovered; depends on pipeline supply (\$5)
Discount creep	₹3.1 cr	Discount 19.3% → 15%	≈ ₹3.4 cr	Recovered, at a small win-rate cost (0.1 pt per pt)

Recovered amounts are the Base driver change applied to the FY29 base, so they are approximations, not separate model lines. The plan recovers the three causes that sales and customer success can fix and about a third of the Helix cause. The rest is why NRR stays below 108% (section 4) and why the product decision in D8 matters.

4. What the plan delivers, and the shortfalls I am defending

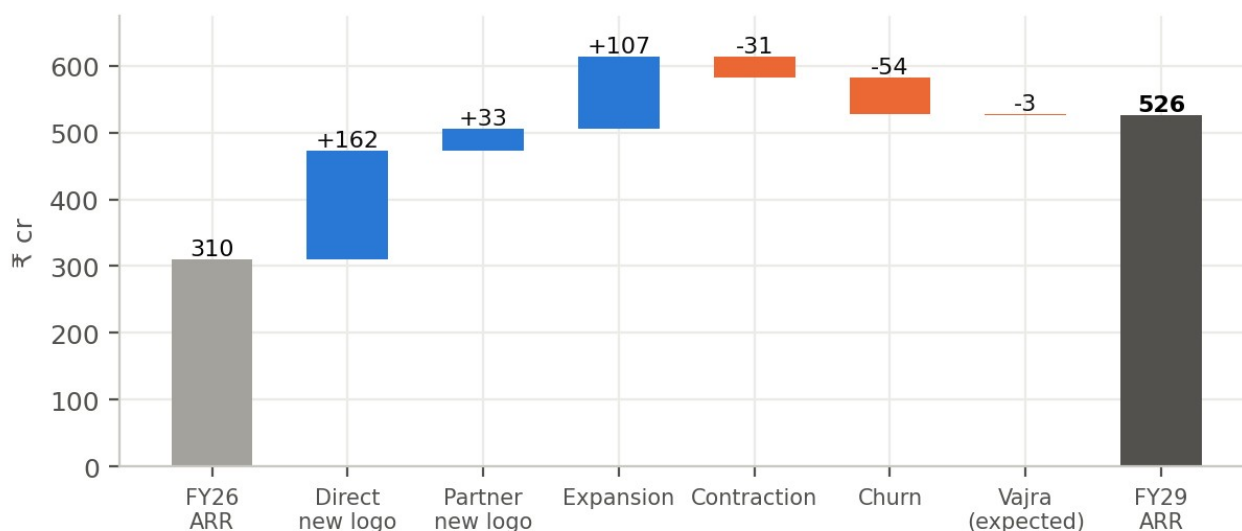


Exhibit 2. FY26 to FY29 ARR bridge, Base (model: ARR_bridge). Expansion is the second-largest source after direct new logos.

₹ crore	FY27	FY28	FY29
Opening ARR	310.0	350.9	422.7
New logo: direct	40.0	55.2	67.2
New logo: partner-sourced	3.7	9.9	19.7
Expansion	26.3	34.4	46.6
Contraction	(9.8)	(10.1)	(11.5)
Churn	(16.8)	(17.6)	(19.2)
Vajra re-tender, expected (Inject 4)	(2.5)	—	—
Closing ARR	350.9	422.7	525.5
Board path	356.5	427.8	521.9
Gap to board path	(5.6)	(5.1)	+3.6
NRR / GRR	99.1% / 90.6%	101.9% / 92.1%	103.8% / 92.7%

FY27 growth: 13.2% against 15%

Three facts make 15% in FY27 hard to buy. Q1 is already set by the pipeline that existed on 1 April (₹8.71 crore forecast, about half of quota). New AEs hired in Q3 produce nothing until their second half-year. And AE capacity binds in the first half: the board path needs 412 qualified deals worked in FY27 against capacity of 380, a gap equal to four fully ramped AEs that cannot be hired and ramped inside the year.

What would close it. A win rate three points above plan takes FY27 to 14.9% (section 9). The Aggressive case (the extra ₹3 crore: six more AEs in Q4 and demand generation) reaches 16.2% but its extra spend does not pay back within the 15 months the CFO set in Inject 1. I recommend holding the ₹15 crore envelope, accepting 13.2%, and recovering the path by FY29, which the Base plan does.

NRR: 103.8% against the 108% goal

D1 and D5 found that the Helix bundle is a packaging and pricing problem that sales effort alone cannot fix; it was worth ₹34 crore a year, ₹25.6 crore of it in retention. The retention programmes lift NRR from 98.9% to 103.8%. Reaching 108% needs about two more points of churn reduction and two more points of expansion, which I tie to the sensor-agnostic tier (no earlier than Q4 FY27): it lets Helix-incumbent plants keep their Helix sensors and add our analytics. I have not put that effect in the Base plan because the product is not yet built; it is upside, decided in D8.

Partner share: 22.7% against 25%

Partner ARR is exactly D6's plan (₹19.7 crore in FY29), but direct new logos grow faster than D6 assumed, so the share is lower. Reaching 25% needs about ₹22 crore of partner ARR, roughly three more activations in FY28. I would not buy those ahead of evidence: D6's kill gate at end-Q2 FY28 decides whether the channel scales.

FY27 by quarter: the view the forecast and the Q2 review use

₹ crore	Q1 FY27	Q2 FY27	Q3 FY27	Q4 FY27	FY27
Direct new logo	7.97 (locked forecast less partner)	10.12	10.73	11.20	40.02
Partner-sourced new logo	0.74	0.85	1.00	1.11	3.70
Expansion	6.16	6.41	6.71	7.04	26.31
Contraction + churn	(6.68)	(6.64)	(6.63)	(6.62)	(26.57)
Vajra re-tender (expected)	—	—	—	(2.51)	(2.51)
Closing ARR	318.2	328.9	340.7	350.9	350.9
Direct win rate (plan path)	17.7%	18.3%	18.9%	19.5%	18.6%
Pipeline required (direct ARR ÷ win rate)	45.0	55.3	56.8	57.5	214.5
AEs (end of quarter)	64	64	69	69	
S&M	26.8	28.6	30.9	30.9	117.1
CAC payback (months)	31.0	28.9	29.4	28.1	29.3
EBITDA	(7.9)	(7.0)	(6.7)	(4.3)	(25.9)

5. Capacity and pipeline arithmetic

	FY27	FY28	FY29	Note
AEs at year end (net new in year)	69 (+6)	77 (+8)	83 (+6)	Fractions from attrition timing; guardrail ≤ 76 in FY27
Ramped-AE equivalents (average)	47.2	53.7	61.1	FY26: 48.5
Effective AE attrition	24%	22%	20%	FY26: 29%
AE deal capacity (qualified deals / year)	380	450	534	Ramped AEs × 5.4 × 12 ÷ cycle
Qualified pipeline supply (deals / year)	380	430	470	D2 tiering and programme reallocation
Deals worked / won	374 / 67	427 / 89	470 / 104	Binding: AE capacity in H1 FY27, pipeline supply from Q3 FY27
Required direct pipeline = direct ARR ÷ win rate	₹214.5 cr	₹265.8 cr	₹303.9 cr	Matches the D4 coverage logic
Partner pipeline required vs partner capacity	₹10.9 / 11.4 cr	₹29.0 / 30.4 cr	₹58.0 / 60.8 cr	Fits, with little headroom

The most useful finding in the model: from Q3 FY27, pipeline supply, not AE headcount, limits bookings. That is why a one-month shorter sales cycle adds only ₹0.6 crore to FY29 ARR, and why AE attrition staying at 29% costs only ₹1.6 crore. It changes the hiring rule: FY28–29 hires are released only when AE capacity use exceeds 90% for two quarters running. In FY29 the plan runs at 88%, so the six FY29 hires are conditional, not committed. A 10% shortfall in qualified pipeline would cost ₹15.4 crore of FY29 ARR and push Q3 FY27 CAC payback to 31 months.

6. Profit and loss, gross margin and payback

₹ crore	FY26 actual	FY27	FY28	FY29
Revenue (subscription + hardware)	388.5	429.6	511.3	619.4
Gross margin after partner margin	68.3%	68.6%	67.5%	67.7%
Partner margin in cost of revenue	0.4 (in S&M today)	0.6	1.9	4.4
S&M (existing lines / all AE pay / initiatives)	96.0	117.1 (64.0 / 40.8 / 12.4)	129.1 (67.8 / 48.8 / 12.5)	142.0 (71.9 / 56.5 / 13.7)
S&M as % of closing ARR	31.0%	33.4%	30.6%	27.0%
R&D / G&A	123.3 / 69.4	131.3 / 72.1	138.6 / 75.0	146.9 / 78.0
EBITDA	(23.3)	(25.9)	2.6	52.6
CAC payback (annual, months)	26.8	29.3	23.1	18.8

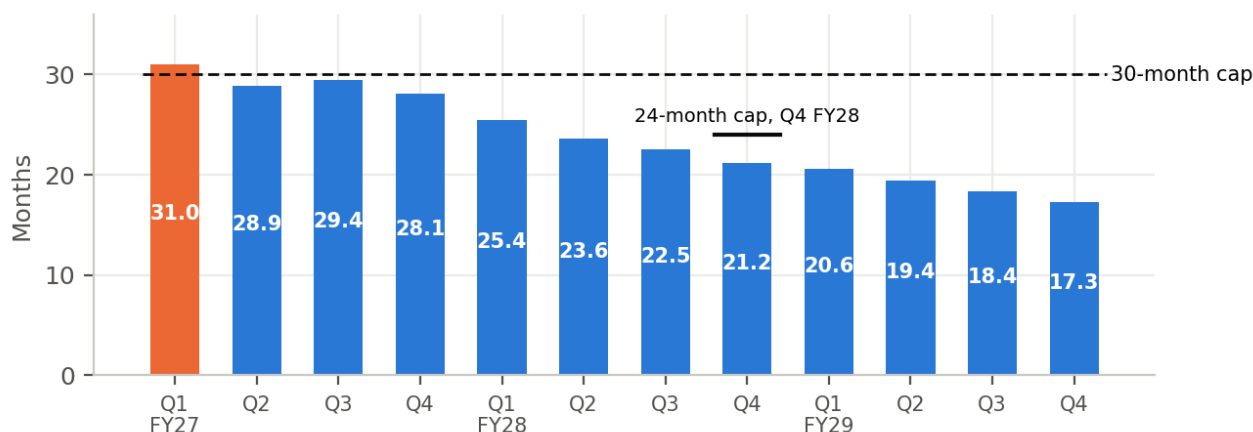


Exhibit 3. Quarterly CAC payback ($S\&M \div ((\text{new} + \text{expansion ARR}) \times \text{gross margin}) \times 12$). Q1 FY27 breaches the 30-month cap; Q3 FY27 is the tightest quarter the plan controls.

The one guardrail breach. Q1 FY27 CAC payback is 31.0 months. Bookings for that quarter were fixed by the 1 April pipeline, and nothing approved now can change them; the programmes start in Q2 so they do not add to Q1 spend. I ask the board for an explicit exception for Q1 FY27 only. From Q2 FY27 every quarter is within 30 months, but Q3 FY27 sits at 29.4: a win rate 0.7 points below plan breaks it. That is why the H2 reserve is released only if the Q2 win-rate trigger is met.

The margin risk nobody has priced. Hardware sells at about 25% gross margin and attaches to every rupee of new and expansion ARR (₹1.48 of hardware per ₹1 of ARR in FY26, rising from ₹1.34 in FY24). Growth therefore dilutes gross margin. If attach stays at the FY26 level, gross margin falls to 65.9% in FY28 and 64.5% in FY29, breaking the floor. The plan assumes attach falls to ₹1.05 by FY29 through software-led expansion and the sensor-agnostic tier. This is the assumption the CFO should test hardest, and it links the CPO's sensor-agnostic question in D8 directly to the margin guardrail.

7. Headcount, spend and payback by year

	FY27	FY28	FY29
AEs (end of year)	69	77	83 (6 conditional)
Channel roles (VP + partner managers)	3	5	6
Customer success (retention squads)	+4, +4 from Q3 if reserve released	8	8
Value engineer / solutions architect / RevOps / pilot SEs	1 / 1 / 2 / 3	same	same
Incremental investment (₹ cr)	14.95	20.35	26.55
of which net new AE pay and recruiting	1.99	7.83	12.88
of which channel foundation	2.44	3.46	4.00
of which reserve lines (released at Q2 review)	2.82	2.04	2.16
Cumulative investment (₹ cr)	14.95	35.30	61.85
Investment payback vs do-nothing (months)	30.8	11.7	8.0
Investment payback vs FY26-flat (months)	78.0	16.5	10.5

FY27 alone does not pay back on the stricter test (78 months), because a quarter of the year is gone and hires ramp slowly. The case rests on FY28–29, which is why the Q2 FY27 triggers matter: they are the earliest point at which the board can see whether the FY28 inflection is coming.

8. Scenarios, sensitivity and break-even

	Base	Downside	Aggressive (₹18 cr)	CFO-capped
What changes	Recommended	Same spend; weaker win, retention, partners	Extra ₹3 cr; 12 AEs in FY27	Reserve never released; FY28–29 hiring frozen
FY29 ARR (₹ cr)	525.5	419.1	598.0	491.6
Growth FY27 / FY28 / FY29	13.2% / 20.4% / 24.3%	7.7% / 10.5% / 13.6%	16.2% / 26.3% / 31.4%	11.8% / 17.6% / 20.6%
NRR FY29	103.8%	98.9%	106.6%	102.1%

	Base	Downside	Aggressive (₹18 cr)	CFO-capped
Lowest gross margin	67.5%	69.1%	66.7%	68.0%
Worst CAC payback from Q2 FY27 / Q4 FY28	29.4 / 21.2	36.0 / 30.9	27.2 / 18.3	29.6 / 22.5
EBITDA FY29 (₹ cr)	52.6	-19.8	92.7	36.8
Investment FY27 / FY27–29	15.0 / 61.9	15.0 / 61.9	17.3 / 77.7	13.0 / 48.9
Guardrails failed (incl. Q1 FY27 payback)	1	3	1	1

The Downside is the case to fear: same spend, weak outcomes, ARR ₹419 crore, EBITDA still negative in FY29 and CAC payback above 30 months from Q2 FY27. The triggers in section 12 exist to detect it by the end of Q2 and move to the CFO-capped path, which protects cash at the cost of ₹34 crore of FY29 ARR.

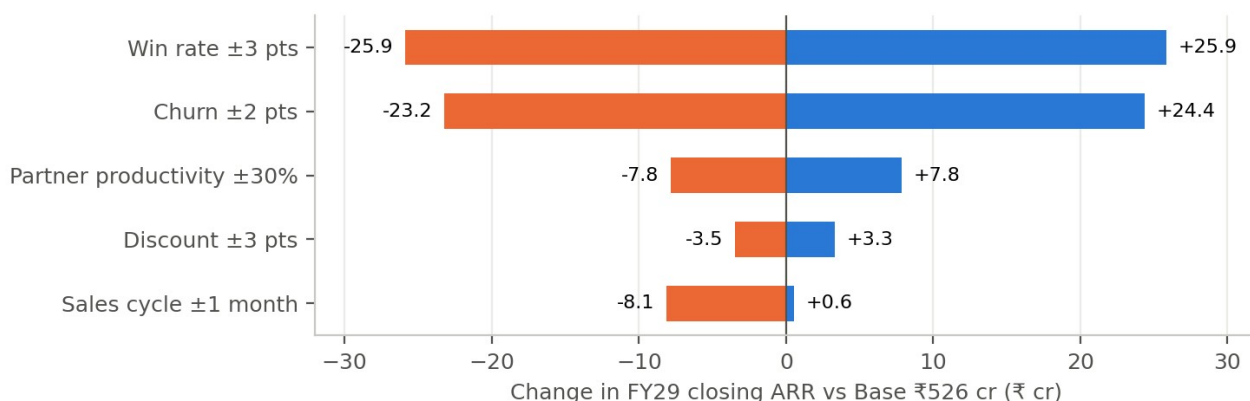


Exhibit 4. FY29 ARR sensitivity, one driver at a time (model: Sensitivity). Win rate and churn dominate; the sales cycle matters only if it gets worse, because pipeline supply binds.

Break-even: the change at which a payback test fails	Win rate vs plan	Churn vs plan	Share of planned improvement delivered
CAC payback above 30 months in any quarter from Q2 FY27	-0.711 pts	+8.0 pts	below 78%
CAC payback above 24 months at Q4 FY28	-4.1 pts	does not bind	below 59%
Investment payback above 30 months (vs FY26-flat, FY29)	-7.9 pts	+6.1 pts	below 32%

Where the investment stops paying back. The investment as a whole is robust: it keeps paying back within 30 months unless win rate falls eight points below plan (below FY26's level), churn rises six points, or less than a third of the planned improvement arrives. The payback guardrails are far less forgiving. The every-quarter CAC test fails if win rate is 0.7 points below plan or 78% of the improvement arrives; the 24-month Q4 FY28 test fails at four points or 59%. The plan is therefore more likely to break a guardrail than to destroy value, and the triggers are set against the guardrails.

9. Cascade test: win rate plus three points

Setting the win-rate shift to 3 in the Assumptions sheet moves every dependent number. The Cascade sheet shows the saved Base, the saved +3 run and the live value side by side.

Metric	Where it shows	Base	+3 pts	Change
Deals won FY27	D2 capacity / D4	67.3	75.7	+8.4
Direct new-logo ARR FY27 (₹ cr)	D4 forecast	40.0	45.0	+5.0
Direct new-logo ARR Q2 FY27 (₹ cr)	D4 next quarter	10.1	11.8	+1.7
Pipeline required FY27 (₹ cr)	D4 coverage	214.5	207.7	-6.8
Board path FY27: capacity gap (deals)	D2 account plan capacity	(32)	+28	+60
Extra ramped AEs needed for board path FY27	D2 / hiring	4.0	0	-4.0
Partner-sourced ARR FY29 (₹ cr)	D6 channel	19.7	21.4	+1.7
Channel saving vs direct FY29 (₹ cr)	D6 channel P&L	11.7	13.3	+1.6
Partner share FY29	D6 / objective 5	22.7%	21.9%	-0.7 pts
Closing ARR FY27 / FY28 / FY29 (₹ cr)	D7 bridge	350.9 / 422.7 / 525.5	356.3 / 437.0 / 551.4	+5.4 / +14.4 / +25.9

Metric	Where it shows	Base	+3 pts	Change
Growth FY27	Guardrail	13.2%	14.9%	+1.7 pts
Revenue FY29 (₹ cr)	P&L	619.4	653.4	+34.0
Gross margin FY29	Guardrail	67.7%	67.2%	−0.5 pts
EBITDA FY27 / FY29 (₹ cr)	P&L	(25.9) / 52.6	(22.4) / 72.1	+3.5 / +19.5
CAC payback Q4 FY28 (months)	Guardrail	21.2	19.6	−1.7
S&M as % of ARR FY29	Guardrail	27.0%	25.7%	−1.3 pts
Investment payback vs do-nothing FY29 (months)	D8	8.0	6.8	−1.2
Unchanged: AE capacity, NRR, partner pipeline required, Q1 FY27	Explained			Capacity does not depend on win rate; NRR is existing customers; Q1 is locked

Three second-order effects are worth saying aloud: partner share falls slightly because direct grows faster; gross margin dips because more new ARR brings more low-margin hardware; and three points of win rate would almost close the FY27 gap on its own.

10. Inject 4: Vajra Auto Components re-tender (₹9.5 crore, renewal Q4 FY27)

Vajra is a top-five customer and 3.1% of ARR. It is a Helix-incumbent plant, HelixAsset is free to Helix customers until 31 March 2027 (Inject 2), and the Helix bundle is the largest churn driver in D1. Without a plan I put the chance of losing it at 45%, with a 15% price concession if we keep it reactively.

	Q4 FY27 ARR lost (₹ cr)	FY27 closing ARR (₹ cr)	FY27 NRR	FY27 growth
Expected, with retention plan (20% loss, 8% concession)	2.5	350.9	99.1%	13.2%
Retained at 8% concession	0.8	352.7	99.7%	13.8%
Lost	9.5	344.0	96.9%	11.0%
Expected, without a plan (45% loss, 15% concession)	5.1	348.4	98.3%	12.4%

Retention plan (₹0.9 crore from the reserve, released now as a defensive item). CEO and CRO meet Vajra's MD and CFO by week 10 to shape the re-tender criteria; a business review built from Vajra's own usage data (assets monitored, failures caught, downtime avoided, using the D3 value model); a three-year renewal with price lock and an 8% concession inside the D5 15% limit, plus expansion to its two uncovered plants; the MES integration pack and a named executive sponsor; and no matching of "free", since HelixAsset's free period ends on 31 March 2027. Expected ARR saved is ₹2.55 crore for ₹0.9 crore, a payback of about six months.

Effect on the forecast. Q4 FY27 net ARR added is ₹10.2 crore expected, ₹12.0 crore if Vajra renews and ₹3.2 crore if it leaves. The D4 forecast process treats Vajra as a named line from Q3 FY27, reported separately from new-logo bookings. Losing Vajra costs about 2.3 points of FY27 NRR and ₹7.4 crore of FY29 ARR.

11. Sequencing by quarter

When	What starts or is decided	Headcount and spend
Q1 FY27 (Apr–Jun, under way)	D4 forecast rules and hygiene flags live; CRM cleaning rules (D1); D2 tiers applied to territories; discount cap 15% with CFO approval above; battlecards v1.1 (Inject 2); P05/P11 restricted (Inject 3); VP Channel search	No new spend; Q1 locked at ₹8.71 cr forecast
Q2 FY27 (Jul–Sep)	Retention squad and adoption programme; Helix renewal protection; top-30 expansion programme; value-selling training and value engineer; pilot SEs; RevOps; AE retention pool; sign PR01, PR02, PR06; partner manager 1; Vajra executive meeting and business review; Q2 review gate (15 Oct)	₹10.1 cr of FY27 programme budget starts (excl. AE pay and reserve); 4 CSMs, 1 value engineer, 1 architect, 2 RevOps, 2 SEs, VP Channel
Q3 FY27 (Oct–Dec)	Six AEs start (SEA-weighted); reserve released if triggers met: second retention squad, SE pilot capacity; partner manager 2; PR07 signed; Vajra three-year offer	+6 AEs; +4 CSMs, +1 SE (if released)

When	What starts or is decided	Headcount and spend
Q4 FY27 (Jan–Mar)	Vajra decision; HelixAsset free period ends 31 Mar 2027: Helix-incumbent win-back campaign; sensor-agnostic tier go/no-go with cannibalisation guard (D8); FY28 hiring released against the 90% capacity-use rule	FY27 total ₹14.95 cr
FY28	8 AEs (Q1, Q3); 9 partner activations; channel kill gate at end-Q2; CAC payback ≤ 24 months by Q4	₹20.4 cr; 5 channel roles
FY29	6 AEs, conditional on capacity use; 5 partner activations; review of NRR programme against 108%	₹26.6 cr; 6 channel roles

12. Risks and early-warning triggers

Risk	Probability	FY29 ARR impact (model)	Mitigation and fallback
Helix pressure deeper than planned (churn 2 pts higher)	Medium (35%)	–₹23 cr	Second retention squad; Helix win-back from Apr 2027; sensor-agnostic tier. Fallback: CFO-capped path
Win-rate programme stalls (3 pts below plan)	Medium (30%)	–₹26 cr; CAC breach from 0.7 pts	Q2 trigger holds the H2 reserve; SEs redeployed to Tier 1 deals
Qualified pipeline 10% below supply plan	Medium (30%)	–₹15 cr; Q3 FY27 CAC 31 months	Programme budget moves to strategic/scaled tiers; FY28 hiring held
Hardware attach does not fall	Medium (35%)	None on ARR; GM 65.9% (FY28), 64.5% (FY29)	Hardware pricing floor; software-led expansion bundles; sensor-agnostic tier
Partners perform like FY26 India partners	Low–medium (25%)	–₹8 cr at –30% productivity	D6 kill gate at end-Q2 FY28
Vajra lost	Low (20%)	–₹7.4 cr; FY27 NRR –2.3 pts	Retention plan; exec sponsor; reference accounts
AE attrition stays at 29%	Medium (40%)	–₹1.6 cr (pipeline binds)	Retention pool; slower backfill is tolerable

Triggers for Q1 and Q2 FY27 (review dates 15 July and 15 October 2026)

Programme	Leading indicator	Q1 threshold	Q2 threshold	If missed at Q2
Targeting	Share of AE touches in strategic and scaled tiers	≥ 55%	≥ 70%	Reassign territories; freeze low-touch AE activity
Win rate and price	Qualified win rate (rolling two quarters); average discount on wins	≥ 17.5%; ≤ 18.5%	≥ 18.0%; ≤ 18%	Hold H2 reserve (₹1.92 cr); redeploy SEs
Pipeline supply	New qualified direct deals created	≥ 90	≥ 95	Move programme budget; delay Q3 hires
Forecast	Actual vs D4 forecast	Q1 within ±15% of ₹8.71 cr	Q2 within ±15%	Recalibrate; review Commit rules
Retention	Churn + contraction; Helix-incumbent renewals kept by value	≤ ₹6.8 cr; ≥ 85%	H1 ≤ ₹13.5 cr; ≥ 85%	Release second squad early (if win trigger met) or cut expansion spend
Expansion	Expansion ARR	≥ ₹6.0 cr	H1 ≥ ₹12.5 cr	Re-scope top-30 programme
Vajra (Inject 4)	Executive meeting; business review; shortlist status	Meeting by week 10	Review delivered; not shortlisted on price alone	CEO escalation with three-year offer
AE capacity	Annualised AE attrition; offers accepted for Q3 start	≤ 27%	≤ 26%; 6 offers by 31 Aug	Retention pool review; do not over-hire (pipeline binds)
Channel (D6)	Partners signed; registered partner pipeline; P05/P11 Helix-account registrations	—	3 signed; ≥ ₹6 cr; 0	Stop wave-2 recruiting
Payback	Quarterly CAC payback	Reported (exception)	≤ 30 months	Move to CFO-capped path
Sensor-agnostic tier	Readiness: cannibalisation test design, 3 pilot plants signed	Design approved	3 pilots signed	Defer launch beyond Q4 FY27

Continue, adjust or stop. All Q2 thresholds met: release the reserve and continue. Win-rate or pipeline thresholds missed: hold the reserve (CFO-capped path) and adjust. Win rate below 17% and CAC payback above 32 months at Q2: stop the Q3 hires and return to the board.

13. What the company stops doing

- **Stop sending AEs to the 1,600 low-touch accounts.** They took 62% of AE touches and produced 12% of won ARR (D2). They move to SDRs, inside sales, marketing and partners.
- **Stop discounting above 15% without CFO approval, and stop matching “free”.** Discount creep bought little win rate (D1, D5); Inject 2 is answered with a three-year value case, not a price match.
- **Stop calling a deal Commit before stage 5.** Commit calls missed by 27% on average (D4); the forecast now uses the calibrated model and the new category rules.
- **Stop planning on a six-month AE ramp and quota without ramp relief.** Measured ramp is 12–24 months to full productivity (D1); quota for new AEs is prorated on the ramp weights in this model.
- **Stop keeping dormant partners and booking partner margin in S&M.** Five partners exit (D6); partner margin is charged to gross margin so the 66% floor is tested honestly.
- **Stop hiring AEs to quota.** From Q3 FY27, pipeline supply binds; hires are released only when AE capacity use exceeds 90% for two quarters.

14. Limits of the evidence, and the assumption I am least sure of

Least sure: the hardware attach rate falling from ₹1.48 to ₹1.05 per rupee of new and expansion ARR.

It is not a sales assumption, it has no direct evidence in the data room beyond the FY24–26 trend (which is rising, not falling), and it alone decides whether the 66% gross margin floor holds in FY28–29. If it does not fall, the plan still grows ARR but breaks the margin guardrail, and the sensor-agnostic tier becomes a margin necessity rather than an option.

- **Driver sizes are judgements.** The model links each programme to a driver, but how far each driver moves rests on D1–D6 evidence, not on a controlled test. The “share of plan delivered” lever shows how much can be missed before each payback test fails (section 8).
- **Primary evidence is incomplete.** The eight structured interviews and the five external benchmarks the brief requires are in progress; assumptions that rest on interview codes (discount response, sensor reuse) are flagged in Appendix A until the interviews are coded.
- **Synthetic data.** All figures come from a synthetic data room. Where the data contradicted the brief (for example, the 24% forecast miss is against reported, not cleaned, bookings), the data was used and the difference stated.
- **The hold-out test is still to come.** The Q1 FY27 forecast (₹8.71 crore) is locked and will be scored against actuals after D8. If it misses by more than 15%, the Q1 anchor in this model and the calibration factor are revisited.

15. Owning and running the model

RevOps owns the workbook. Actuals replace plan quarter by quarter in the ARR bridge; the Checks sheet must show zero errors before any number leaves the building. Every board or CFO figure is a view of this model, not a private spreadsheet. Changes to Base assumptions need CRO and CFO sign-off and are logged on the Traceability sheet. The model is re-run for all four scenarios at each quarterly review, and the saved-run sheets (Scenarios, Sensitivity, Cascade) are regenerated with `run_scenarios.py` so that the saved and live numbers never drift apart.

Appendix A. Traceability map

Assumption	Base value	Source	From
Opening ARR and FY26 bridge	₹310 cr; +41, +22, -9, -16	DR3 P&L; DR2 ARR movements	D1
Direct win rate FY26	17.1%	DR1 cleaned (duplicates, tests, DQ-as-lost removed)	D1
Win-rate path	19.5 / 21.5 / 22.5%	D2 tier mix (+2.9 pts); D5 (+0.6 pts beyond D2); Inject 2 Helix floor 7%	D2, D5
Sales cycle	8.1 → 7.3 months	DR1 stage history; D4 stage-exit rules; D3	D1, D3, D4
Deal size and discount	₹71.4 → 77 lakh list; 19.3% → 15%	DR1 FY26 wins; D3 negotiation plan; D5 limits	D3, D5
Win-rate response to discount	0.1 pt per pt	D1 discount-creep test; D5 interview code (to validate)	D1, D5
Qualified pipeline supply	380 / 430 / 470	DR1 FY26 392; D2 tiering and ₹24 cr reallocation	D2
Deals carried per ramped AE	5.4	DR3 ae_quarterly × DR1 closes and cycle	D1, D2
Ramp weights	0 / 0.33 / 0.66 / 1.0	D1 productivity by tenure (DR3)	D1
AE attrition	29% → 24 / 22 / 20%	DR3 roster; Inject 1 retention pool	D1, Inject 1
Net new AEs	6 / 8 / 6	Inject 1; guardrail ≤ 12	Inject 1
Q1 FY27 new logo	₹8.71 cr	D4 locked forecast (sha256 ba5b63ad...)	D4
Partner activations, productivity, ramp	8 / 9 / 5; ₹1.2 cr; 15 / 60 / 100%	DR6; D1 SEA partner win 34%	D6
Existing partner ARR after Inject 3	₹2.26 cr	DR1 open pipeline; P05/P11 haircut	D6
Partner margins; channel fixed cost	16–18%; ₹2.44 / 3.46 / 4.0 cr	D6 programme; DR3 partner-manager cost	D6
Expansion / contraction / churn	8.5 → 10.5% / 3.0 → 2.5% / 5.0 → 4.0%	DR2, DR3; D1 NRR diagnosis; Inject 1; Inject 2	D1
Vajra	20% loss; 8% concession	Inject 4; DR2 CU-1095; D5	D7
Hardware attach	1.48 → 1.05	DR3 FY24–26; D1 SENSOR-REUSE code	D1, D8
Cost of revenue	Software 18%; hardware 75%	DR3	DR3
S&M base; AE cost; recruiting	₹60.3 cr; ₹0.56 cr; ₹3.5 lakh	DR3 S&M by line; unit costs	DR3
Investment lines FY27	₹14.95 cr	Inject 1 envelope	Inject 1
R&D / G&A growth	6% / 4%	Assumption (no new hardware)	D7
Do-nothing trends	New logo -5%/yr; NRR -1 pt/yr	D1 FY24–26 trends	D1
Guardrails; CAC definition	Brief §4, §6; DR3 definitions	Brief; DR3	—
Primary evidence	8 interviews (in progress)	Interview kit and log; interview-based assumptions flagged until coded	Kit

Appendix B. Checks sheet (Base)

Check	Value	Result
ARR bridge ties every quarter	0.000	OK
No formula errors in model sheets	0	OK
New logo = direct + partner (counted once)	0.000	OK
Investment within FY27 envelope	₹14.95 cr of ₹15 cr	OK
Gross margin ≥ 66% (lowest year)	67.5%	OK
CAC payback ≤ 30 months, worst quarter	31.0 (Q1 FY27)	BREACH: exception requested
CAC payback ≤ 24 months by Q4 FY28	21.2	OK
S&M ≤ 30% of ARR by FY29	27.0%	OK
Net new AEs FY27 ≤ 12; headcount ≤ 76	6; 69	OK
Channel roles ≤ 6	3	OK
Pipeline: deals worked ≤ AE capacity and ≤ supply, every quarter	0 exceptions	OK
Partner pipeline ≤ partner capacity	0 exceptions	OK

Check	Value	Result
Growth FY27 / FY28 / FY29	13.2% / 20.4% / 24.3%	FY27 SHORTFALL (defended)
NRR FY29 vs 108%	103.8%	SHORTFALL (defended)
Partner share FY29 vs 25%	22.7%	SHORTFALL (defended)
D6 reconciliation: partner ARR FY27–29 = ₹33.27 cr	₹33.27 cr	OK

External benchmarks (five independent sources required by the brief) are still to be added from the student's own research; the DR8 ranges were not used as inputs.